PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | SIEM/SOAR | CrowdStrike Falcon | Incident Response | Detection Engineering

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Senior Cyber Security Engineer with over five years of deep, hands-on expertise in Security Information and Event Management (SIEM), Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR), Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) with CrowdStrike Falcon, and enterprise incident response. I have led security engineering and security operations functions in complex environments, most recently at the University of the Arts London (UAL) where I protect an 8,000-user hybrid estate using CrowdStrike Falcon, Microsoft Sentinel, and the full Microsoft Defender Extended Detection and Response (XDR) platform. I excel at detection engineering, threat hunting, and building SIEM detection content and SOAR automation that enables small, high-performing security teams to operate efficiently at scale. I combine strong technical depth with the ability to manage and communicate across a small team and to senior stakeholders, and I bring proven experience in vulnerability management, identity security with Microsoft Entra ID, and aligning security operations to recognised frameworks including the MITRE ATT&CK framework and NIST SP 800-61. I hold the Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) certification.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM and Detection Engineering:** Microsoft Sentinel (Kusto Query Language/KQL), CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM), Splunk/SPL, MITRE ATT&CK-mapped detection rule development, alert tuning and noise reduction
- **Endpoint Detection and Response:** CrowdStrike Falcon (EDR, Prevent, Insight, Discover, Falcon X Threat Intelligence), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Defender XDR
- **SOAR and Automation:** Microsoft Sentinel SOAR playbooks, PowerShell scripting, Logic Apps, automated alert triage and incident enrichment, automated containment actions
- **Incident Response:** NIST SP 800-61, MITRE ATT&CK, threat hunting, forensic investigation, alert triage, containment, eradication, lessons-learned
- **Identity and Access Security:** Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access, Privileged Identity Management (PIM), Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM), Single Sign-On (SSO)
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Nessus, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck, risk-based remediation
- **Cloud and Platform Security:** Microsoft Azure, Microsoft 365 (M365) security, Defender for Cloud, Amazon Web Services (AWS) security controls
- **Endpoint and Device Management:** Microsoft Intune, Mobile Device Management (MDM), Tanium, Group Policy
- **Other Tools:** Check Point Harmony firewall, Mimecast, Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI)
- **Frameworks:** NIST CSF, CIS Controls, ISO/IEC 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) — Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 – Present*

- Lead SIEM engineering and security operations in Microsoft Sentinel, designing and writing KQL-based detection rules mapped to MITRE ATT&CK tactics and techniques, maintaining and tuning analytics to reduce false-positive rates across the 8,000-user hybrid estate.
- Oversee CrowdStrike Falcon EDR and NG-SIEM deployment, performing proactive threat hunting using Falcon Insight, correlating endpoint telemetry with Sentinel alerts to identify and respond to advanced threats.
- Engineer and operate SOAR automation playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel, automating alert triage, threat enrichment, incident containment steps, and notifications to reduce manual analyst workload and improve response consistency.
- Lead incident response activities following NIST SP 800-61, managing investigation, containment, eradication, and recovery for security incidents across endpoints, cloud, and identities, and producing post-incident reports and lessons-learned documentation.

- Manage the full Microsoft Defender XDR platform (Defender for Endpoint, Defender for Identity, Defender for Office 365), delivering unified detection and response across endpoints, accounts, and email workloads.
- Direct enterprise vulnerability management using Tenable.io and Pentera BAS, coordinating risk-based remediation across infrastructure and application teams.
- Manage Entra ID identity security, including Conditional Access, Privileged Identity Management, MFA, and SSO governance, reducing identity-based attack surface.
- Mentor junior analysts and produce security reporting and risk metrics for senior leadership and governance stakeholders.

University of the Arts, London (UAL) — Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity *March 2022 – March 2025*

- Monitored and triaged security alerts across Microsoft Sentinel SIEM, CrowdStrike Falcon, and Defender XDR, investigating incidents using NIST SP 800-61 methodology and documenting findings and remediation steps.
- Authored and tuned detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel using KQL, working to reduce alert fatigue and improve signal-to-noise ratio across the SIEM platform.
- Performed ongoing vulnerability assessments using Tenable.io, Nessus, and AppCheck, tracking critical findings and coordinating remediation with infrastructure teams.
- Administered BeyondTrust PAM to control and audit privileged access to critical systems, enforcing least-privilege principles.
- Supported configuration of CrowdStrike Falcon policies including prevention rules, response actions, and Falcon X threat intelligence integration.
- Assisted in Cyber Essentials Plus certification and ISO/IEC 27001 control alignment activities, producing evidence and assessment reports.
- Authored incident response playbooks, detection runbooks, and standard operating procedures for the security operations function.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) — IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure *February 2021 – March 2022*

- Managed security operations for a Software as a Service (SaaS) FinTech organisation, including endpoint protection, vulnerability management, incident investigation, and patch management.
- Configured and maintained Azure and M365 security controls including Defender for Endpoint, Conditional Access, and Intune endpoint policies, ensuring CIS Benchmark and ISO/IEC 27001 compliance.
- Responded to security incidents, conducting root cause analysis and implementing corrective controls to reduce recurrence risk.
- Supported implementation of SSO and MFA across SaaS application integrations, reducing identity-based risk for internal and customer-facing services.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Built and maintains a comprehensive library of MITRE ATT&CK-aligned KQL detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel, significantly reducing false-positive volumes and enabling a small security team to respond efficiently to real threats.
- Deployed and operationalised CrowdStrike Falcon EDR and Microsoft Defender XDR across 8,000 users, achieving unified threat visibility across endpoints, identities, email, and cloud workloads in a compact security engineering team.
- Engineered SOAR automation in Microsoft Sentinel that eliminated manual triage steps for common alert types, freeing analyst capacity for complex investigation and threat hunting.
- Led enterprise vulnerability management using Tenable.io and Pentera BAS, reducing critical endpoint and cloud vulnerability exposure through structured, risk-prioritised remediation programmes.
- Led incident response investigations from detection to closure, applying NIST SP 800-61 methodology and producing actionable post-incident reports with measurable improvements to detection and prevention controls.
- Maintained Cyber Essentials Plus certification for UAL and contributed to ISO/IEC 27001 framework alignment, ensuring the security operations programme meets recognised compliance standards.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)